

TVs

HDTV (FLAGSHIPS)

OLED domination

It's been a good year for televisions so far. Sony jumped onto the OLED bandwagon, while LG made its OLED TVs slimmer and more attractive. Samsung announced its QLED technology, making the QLED Q8C the first TV to cover 100% of the DCI-P3 colour space. There were also new entrants in the high end TV space, with companies like Panasonic selling comparatively cheaper 4K HDR TVs.

Of course, there was improvement in the lower price segments as well, but we're concerned right now with 4K and HDR televisions selling in the country. How did that segment fare? Well, here's are the top picks from this segment.

2017 ZERO1 AWARD WINNER

Sony Bravia A1 65-inch

Sony's entry into the OLED market is good news for everyone. It means we can expect more companies to jump onto the OLED bandwagon in future. However, for 2017, the Zero1 Award for best television in India goes to Sony's A1 65-inch. It's the perfect mix of style and performance, that anyone spending this much money on a television would expect.

On our tests, the Bravia A1 returned contrast ratio ratings of over 180,000:1 at 50% brightness and with no direct light falling on the screen. That's more than any television has achieved



LG OLED 65C7T
65-inch
 Price: ₹4,59,990



Sony Bravia A1
55-inch
 Price: ₹3,64,900

on our tests so far. Sony promises 1000 nits brightness on the panel as well, which is perfect for HDR video as well. Speaking of which, the Bravia A1 is one of the few televisions that offer both Dolby Vision and HDR10 support.

Granted, the Bravia A1 is not the loudest television, but it combined Acoustic Surface technology and a sub-woofer mounted in the kickstand to provide very rich audio output. Explosions sound more real, while dialogue is crisp when watching movies.

RUNNER UP

LG OLED 65C7T 65-inch

LG has always been amongst our favourites when it comes to televisions. Its top TVs lost out to Sony's Z9D last year, and this year the OLED 65C7T takes second place. Now, that doesn't mean this isn't an absolute high end television. In fact, most won't even be able to tell the difference between this and the Bravia A1 mentioned above. Under the same test conditions, the LG television returned contrast ratio readings of about 130,000:1, which is excellent.

What really puts this television behind the others is its audio performance. You would need an external soundbar for a clearer and richer audio. The TV often falters in differentiating dialogues from background scores.

Nevertheless, the LG OLED 65C7T is an excellent TV to buy. It produces excellent picture quality and supports all the newest technologies. LG's WebOS is amongst the better television operating systems today, and the OLED 65C7T would impress anyone who hasn't seen the Sony Bravia A1.

BEST BUY

Sony Bravia A1 55-inch

We were going to give this one to the Samsung QLED Q8C. But inch to inch, the Bravia A1 doesn't only outperform that TV, it also costs the same. So, it only makes sense that the smaller screen size should be the best buy. At 55-inch, it delivers the same picture quality as its larger variant. Given that it's a full ₹1 lakh cheaper than the 65-inch version, it is certainly the best buy amongst top end TVs today. 



Sony Bravia A1 65-inch
 Price: ₹4,64,900